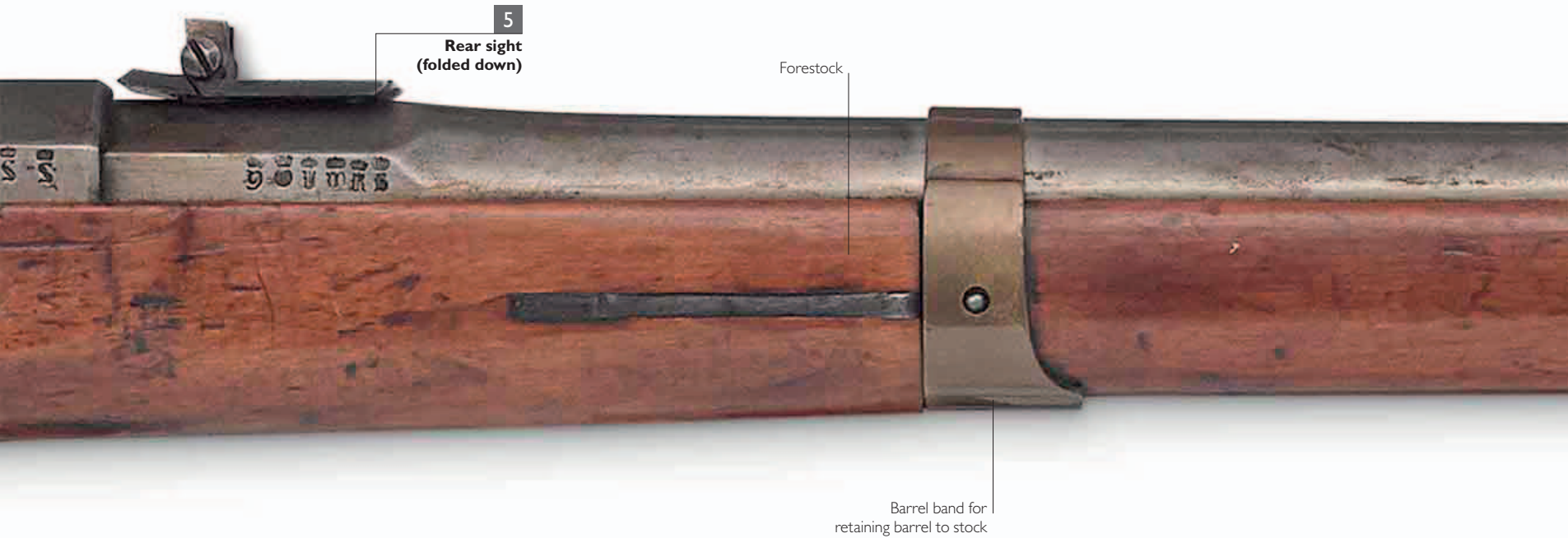


**DREYSE
NEEDLE-FIRE RIFLE****Date** 1841**Origin** Germany**Barrel** 34in (86.5cm)**Caliber** .60in (15.2mm)

Named after its needle-like firing pin, this revolutionary gun introduced bolt action (see p.304) in breech-loading rifles. Bolt-action rifles would lead to the development of repeaters and most automatic weapons. The Dreyse rifle helped to establish Prussia's military supremacy over its neighbors for more than two decades. It could be loaded lying down or kneeling behind cover, unlike muzzle-loaders, which had to be loaded standing up. Bolt action also provided the Dreyse rifle with a higher rate of fire than the muzzle-loaders.

**▲ BOLT HANDLE**

The bolt was turned and moved with this lever, opening and closing the breech for loading. The bolt handle was placed on the right-hand side of the gun, a design feature that would come to be seen on most bolt-action rifles.

**▲ FIRING PIN**

This long pin is hidden within the bolt housing. On pulling the trigger, the firing pin pierced the case of the paper cartridge to strike a percussion cap buried within the gunpowder charge, at the bullet's base. Ignition of the cap detonated this charge inside the cartridge, firing the bullet. The cartridge residue burned away upon firing to leave an empty breech.

**▲ REAR SIGHT**

The rifle has a V-shaped rear sight, located in front of the bolt housing. It was used together with the foresight for aiming the gun.